

SmartCare Multispeciality Hospital — Appointment Policy & Procedure

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1. Purpose & Scope

1.1 Purpose

This policy outlines the official rules, eligibility criteria, booking channels, workflows, cancellation policies, rescheduling timelines, and fee frameworks governing outpatient consultations at SmartCare Multispeciality Hospital. It establishes standard operating procedures for both scheduled appointments and walk-in arrivals.

1.2 Scope

This policy applies to all 21 outpatient clinical departments, subspecialty clinics, diagnostic consultation slots, and health check-up appointments at SmartCare Hospital. It does **not** govern admission to the Emergency Department, which requires immediate clinical triage regardless of appointments.

2. Appointment Booking Channels

SmartCare Hospital offers four official, synchronized booking channels:

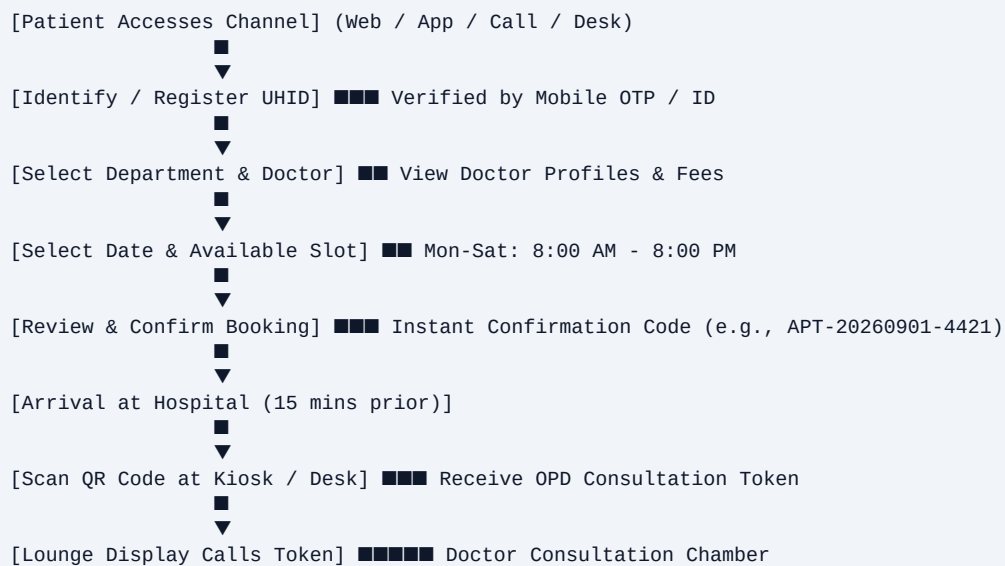
- SmartCare Online Patient Portal & Mobile App:**
 - Available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week.
 - Patients can view live doctor availability, clinical profiles, consultation fees, and select 15-minute consultation slots up to 30 days in advance.
 - Instant SMS, WhatsApp, and email confirmation with a downloadable appointment slip containing a QR check-in code.
 - Central Telephone Booking Desk:**
 - Dedicated appointment phone lines: **+91-40-6999-1111** and **+91-40-6999-1122**.
 - Operating hours: Monday through Saturday, 7:30 AM to 8:30 PM.
 - On-Campus Reception Counters (Walk-in & Advance):**
 - Central OPD Atrium, Counters 1 through 6 on Ground Floor.
 - Self-service interactive digital kiosks in the main lobby.
 - Operating hours: Monday through Saturday, 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM.
 - SmartCare AI Assistant / WhatsApp Booking Bot:**
 - Available 24/7 for automated slot lookup, calendar sync, and booking requests linked to the patient's mobile number and UHID.
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3. Required Patient Information for Booking

To ensure patient identity safety and clinical record continuity, the following data is required at the time of appointment creation:

- **Full Legal Name** (as reflected on Government photo ID)
- **Date of Birth / Age and Gender**
- **Mobile Number** (for SMS/WhatsApp token verification)
- **Email Address** (for digital appointment slip and prescription receipt)
- **Residential City / Pincode**
- **Existing UHID** (if previously registered at SmartCare Hospital)
- **Primary Health Complaint / Reason for Visit** (to ensure accurate specialty routing)
- **Doctor / Specialty Preference**

4. End-to-End Appointment Workflow



5. Standard Appointment Rules & Policies

5.1 Token System & Arrival Window

- **Reporting Time:** Patients are required to arrive at the designated clinic floor **15 minutes prior** to their scheduled slot time to complete preliminary nursing vitals (blood pressure, pulse, temperature, weight).
- **Token Call Sequence:** While appointments are reserved for specific time windows, doctor consultation times may slightly shift due to complex clinical evaluations or emergency consultations. Patients are called by digital token number on the lounge monitors.

5.2 Late Arrival Policy

- **Grace Period:** A 15-minute grace period is provided beyond the scheduled appointment time.
- **Exceeding 15 Minutes:** If a patient arrives more than 15 minutes past their slot, the slot is automatically opened to waiting walk-in patients. The late patient will be accommodated as the next available walk-in at the consultant's discretion.

5.3 Missed Appointments / No-Show Policy

- If a patient does not arrive and fails to cancel or reschedule at least 2 hours before the slot, the booking is marked as a **"No-Show"**.
- Three consecutive no-shows within 60 days will restrict the patient's online booking privileges, requiring them to book via telephone or at the on-campus desk with advance fee payment.

5.4 Walk-In Patients Policy

- Walk-in patients without prior appointments are welcomed from Monday through Saturday, 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM.

- Walk-ins are assigned designated walk-in buffer slots between scheduled appointments or at the conclusion of the consultant's scheduled list.
- Waiting time for walk-in patients typically ranges from 30 to 75 minutes depending on specialty demand.

5.5 Emergency Priority Rule

- **Clinical Priority Clause:** Emergency cases, acute chest pain, trauma, or unstable vitals take immediate precedence over all scheduled outpatient appointments. In such events, OPD patients will be informed by the nursing coordinator of unavoidable delays.

5.6 Consultation Validity & Follow-Up Visits

- **Validity Window:** Every paid outpatient consultation includes **one complimentary follow-up visit within 7 calendar days** for review of prescribed diagnostic reports with the same consultant.
- **Day 8 and Beyond:** Any consultation occurring on or after Day 8 from the initial visit will be registered as a fresh consultation subject to regular consultation fees.

6. Appointment Cancellation Policy

6.1 Cancellation Process

Patients may cancel a scheduled appointment via:

1. SmartCare Mobile App or Patient Web Portal under "My Bookings".
2. Calling Central Booking at **+91-40-6999-1111** (Quote Appointment ID).
3. Replying "CANCEL" to the automated SMS/WhatsApp appointment notification.

6.2 Cancellation Timelines & Refund Matrix

Cancellation Notice Window	Refund Eligibility for Pre-Paid Bookings	Remarks
More than 2 hours before slot	100% Full Refund or 100% Credit Voucher	Credit reflects instantly; bank refund takes 3–5 business days.
Less than 2 hours before slot	80% Refund (20% administrative charge)	May alternately be rescheduled once with zero penalty.
After slot time / No-Show	No Refund	Forfeited due to reserved consultant clinical time.
Cancellation by Hospital / Doctor	100% Full Refund + Priority Rescheduling	Due to doctor emergency surgery or medical leave.

7. Appointment Rescheduling Policy

- **Rescheduling Flexibility:** Patients can reschedule their appointment up to **2 hours prior** to the scheduled slot time without any fee or surcharge.
- **Maximum Rescheduling Limit:** An appointment may be rescheduled a maximum of **two (2) times**. Subsequent changes will require cancellation and a new booking.
- **Procedure:** Log into the SmartCare portal, select the active appointment, click "Reschedule", and choose a newly available date and time slot.

8. Emergency vs. Outpatient Care Notice

CRITICAL CLINICAL BOUNDARY:

Routine outpatient appointments are strictly intended for non-emergency clinical evaluations, chronic disease follow-ups, preventive health checks, and elective consultations.

If you or a loved one is experiencing severe chest pain, sudden numbness or speech difficulty, severe breathing distress, heavy bleeding, sudden loss of consciousness, or major physical trauma, DO NOT BOOK AN OPD APPOINTMENT.

Immediately proceed to the SmartCare Emergency Department at Gate 1 or call the 24/7 Emergency Line at +91-40-6999-0000.

9. RAG Knowledge Search & Question Triggers

- **Trigger Queries:** "How do I book an appointment?", "Can I cancel my doctor appointment?", "I want to change my appointment time", "How much does a consultation cost?", "What is the follow-up validity period?", "What happens if I am late for my appointment?", "Can I see a doctor today without booking?", "How do I get a refund for my cancelled appointment?"
- **Standardized Fact Base:** Appointments can be booked, cancelled, or rescheduled online or by calling +91-40-6999-1111. Cancellations made >2 hours before slot time receive a 100% refund. 7-day free follow-up for report review with the same doctor.

10. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1: How can I book an appointment with a doctor at SmartCare?

A: You can book an appointment online via our website/app, through our WhatsApp assistant, by calling +91-40-6999-1111, or directly at the hospital registration counters on the Ground Floor.

Q2: What are the consultation hours for doctors?

A: Regular doctor consultations are available Monday through Saturday between 8:00 AM and 8:00 PM. Specific doctor clinic shifts vary within this window.

Q3: Can I book an appointment for Sunday?

A: Regular outpatient appointments are not conducted on Sundays. Only emergency, inpatient, and trauma care services operate on Sundays.

Q4: How far in advance can I book an appointment?

A: You can book appointments up to 30 calendar days in advance through the online portal or central calling desk.

Q5: What information do I need to provide when booking an appointment?

A: You need to provide the patient's full name, age, gender, active mobile number, email address, existing UHID (if registered), and the department or doctor you wish to consult.

Q6: How will I know my appointment is confirmed?

A: Upon successful booking, you will instantly receive an SMS and WhatsApp confirmation containing your Appointment ID (e.g., APT-12345), doctor's name, department, date, time slot, and clinic room number.

Q7: Can I cancel my appointment online?

A: Yes. Log into the SmartCare Patient Portal, navigate to "My Bookings", select the appointment, and click "Cancel Appointment". You can also cancel by calling +91-40-6999-1111.

Q8: What is the cancellation refund policy?

A: Cancellations made more than 2 hours prior to the slot receive a 100% refund. Cancellations made less than 2 hours before the slot are eligible for an 80% refund. No-shows are non-refundable.

Q9: How long does a fee refund take to reach my bank account?

A: Refunds processed through online payment gateways typically take 3 to 5 business days to credit back to your original payment card or UPI account.

Q10: Can I reschedule my appointment to another day?

A: Yes, you can reschedule your appointment free of charge up to 2 hours before the scheduled time, up to a maximum of two times.

Q11: What happens if I arrive 20 minutes late for my appointment?

A: If you arrive more than 15 minutes late, your reserved slot is released to avoid delays for subsequent patients. You will be accommodated as a walk-in patient at the next available clinical opening.

Q12: Is there a free follow-up consultation after my initial visit?

A: Yes. SmartCare provides one complimentary follow-up consultation within 7 calendar days from your initial paid visit with the same consultant, specifically to review lab or radiology results.

Q13: Does the 7-day follow-up apply if I see a different doctor?

A: No. The complimentary 7-day follow-up is valid only with the same treating consultant who ordered the investigations.

Q14: Can I walk into the hospital and see a doctor without an appointment?

A: Yes, walk-in patients are registered at Counter 1–6 on the Ground Floor from 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM. Waiting times depend on consultant availability and emergency load.

Q15: How early should I arrive before my appointment?

A: Please arrive 15 minutes prior to your slot time to complete check-in, token generation, and preliminary nursing vital checks (BP, pulse, weight).

Q16: Can I choose a specific doctor for my appointment?

A: Yes, you can select your preferred doctor by name, specialty, clinical experience, and gender when booking online or over the telephone.

Q17: What if my doctor is called into an emergency surgery on the day of my appointment?

A: In rare events of emergency surgical call-ins, our nursing coordinator will immediately notify you. You will be offered the option to consult an associate senior consultant, reschedule at priority, or receive a 100% refund.

Q18: Can I book an appointment for a family member using my phone number?

A: Yes, you can book for family members under your registered account. Ensure you enter the patient's accurate legal name, age, and gender during booking.

Q19: Can international patients book outpatient consultations?

A: Yes, international patients can book through our International Patient Care Desk via email at international@smartcarehospital-demo.org or via phone at +91-40-6999-1133.

Q20: Can I book diagnostic tests (MRI, CT, Ultrasound) along with my doctor appointment?

A: Yes. Diagnostic slots can be booked concurrently through the SmartCare portal or by contacting the Radiology desk at +91-40-6999-4466 after receiving your doctor's requisition.

Q21: How do I know which doctor or department to consult for my symptoms?

A: You can describe your symptoms to the SmartCare AI Assistant or call our Central Helpline (+91-40-6999-1111), where triage staff will direct you to the appropriate clinical department.

Q22: Is there a senior citizen priority booking queue?

A: Yes. Patients aged 65 and above are given dedicated priority registration at Counter 1 and expedited token allocation in OPD waiting lounges.

Q23: Can I book a teleconsultation / video call with a doctor?

A: Yes, teleconsultations are available for select follow-ups and non-emergency specialties via the SmartCare Patient App.

Q24: What documents should I bring to my appointment?

A: Please bring a valid Government photo ID, existing SmartCare UHID card (if available), any past medical records, discharge summaries, current medication strips, and health insurance policy documents.

Q25: Can I book an appointment for someone else if I do not have their ID?

A: You may initiate a booking, but a valid photo ID of the patient must be presented at the hospital registration counter before the consultation token can be issued.

11. Official Contact Directory

- **Central Appointment Booking Desk:** +91-40-6999-1111 / +91-40-6999-1122
- **WhatsApp Appointment Bot:** +91-40-6999-1100
- **Emergency Helpline (24/7):** +91-40-6999-0000
- **Online Booking Portal:** <https://www.smartcarehospital-demo.org/appointments>
- **Appointment Support Email:** appointments@smartcarehospital-demo.org